CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 2

Chapters 9–12: **The Boy Who Broke the Bank, The Visitor (from The Book Thief), Helen Keller (poem) - Langston Hughes, The Stolen Bacillus** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. 'Not very much to see after all' is spoken by the visitor mainly to: 1

(a) insult the Bacteriologist **(b)** ask for money
(c) end the talk **(d)** sound casual about the bacteria

2. Which element builds suspense in the story's middle? 1

(a) a long description of the hills
(b) the use of foreign words
(c) a sad song
(d) the chain of whispered news moving closer to the bank

3. Papa's insistence 'You have to finish that book, like you said' is directed in reality at: 1

(a) Rosa's mother
(b) Max in the basement only
(c) the listening party man, as a performance
(d) Liesel's school teacher

4. The syntax of 'Found light / Brighter than many ever see' omits a subject because: 1

(a) it is a question
(b) the poet forgot
(c) it is a mistake
(d) 'She' from the previous line carries over

5. Minnie's remark 'it's that horrid science of his' shows that she: 1

(a) blames his profession for his strange behaviour
(b) dislikes the Anarchist
(c) loves science
(d) is a doctor

6. If the manager had said 'the bank has ample money' (and the crowd believed him), the likely result would be: 1

(a) the run on the bank would have been avoided
(b) the bank would have collapsed sooner
(c) nothing would change
(d) Nathu would be sacked

7. Which of these is the best antonym of 'perplexed'? 1

(a) bewildered **(b)** clear-headed **(c)** puzzled **(d)** confused

8. Which pair of terms best matches the poem's two dominant images? 1

(a) fire and ice **(b)** city and farm **(c)** dark and light **(d)** sea and sky

9. The story's closing paragraph is told by: 1

(a) the cabman **(b)** the Anarchist

(c) Minnie **(d)** the Bacteriologist, in dialogue

10. Read: 'It was nearly closing time. The clerks shut down their counters.' What effect does this have on the crowd? 1

(a) It pleases them

(b) It calms them

(c) It adds to the suspicion that the bank is hiding something

(d) It makes them leave

11. Extract: 'Their heartbeats fought each other, a mess of rhythm.' The device is: 1

(a) onomatopoeia **(b)** personification

(c) irony **(d)** alliteration only

12. Which best describes the paradox of the poem? 1

(a) a poor person is rich in coins

(b) a lazy person succeeds

(c) a blind person brings light to a seeing world

(d) a loud person is silent

13. Which of the following is a reason the story is called 'The Stolen Bacillus' rather than 'The Anarchist'? 1

(a) the stolen tube drives the entire plot **(b)** the Anarchist is unimportant

(c) the story is about a book **(d)** it is a famous song

14. The author's tone throughout the story is best described as: 1

(a) tragic and grim **(b)** light, humorous and gently satirical

(c) angry and bitter **(d)** solemn and religious

15. The wink given by the party man to Liesel (para 63) leaves the reader feeling: 1

(a) relieved yet uneasy because the danger was close

(b) bored

(c) angry at Liesel

(d) sure that the officer knew the secret

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. Why is Papa's offer of coffee or tea to the officer a clever touch? 2

17. How does the poem reflect the theme of SDG 'Reduced Inequalities'? 2

18. Comment on the cabman's role in the story. 2

19. Explain how reading paragraph 30 aloud would convey Nathu's feelings. 2

20. In what way does the extract question the idea of 'good' and 'bad' people? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Why does the Bacteriologist chase the Anarchist so desperately, and why does the chase turn comic by para 32? 3

22. Explain the difference between 'rumour' and 'news' using the story. 3

23. Combine: 'The officer left. Rosa melted by the stove.' using 'As soon as'. 3

24. Identify the part of speech of each: found, loveliness, brighter. 3

OR

Discuss the effect of the writer's use of third-person narration. 3

25. Discuss the role of the setting (a small hill town) in making the rumour credible. 3

OR

Examine how the narrator addresses the reader and why. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. Imagine you are Seth Govind Ram returning from Kashmir. Write a letter to the townspeople. 5

OR

Imagine you are the party man. Write a diary entry about your day inspecting houses on Himmel Street (keep to what the extract shows). 5

27. Discuss the poem as a response to inequality and prejudice. 5

OR

How does Wells use language (rhetoric, imagery, short sentences) to make the story effective? 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 50 Marks

MASTERMIND